heard of these, and thanks to recent regulation, you will have needed to give permission for their use on just about all websites based in an EU country. HTTP cookies are a client-side data storage mechanism, with a persistence mechanism operating via the client filesystem (cookies are not "the files" per se; some only ever live in memory) and important enough to have dedicated PHP functions and their own honorable mention later in this section.

Finally, after the request line and headers are sent, the request may then contain an optional body. The request body is simply arbitrary data that the server generally requires to successfully complete the request. This data might be an encoded set of fields and values, a web form submission, or a stream of JSON (JavaScript Object Notation) formatted text. It could even be binary data, which presents some challenges, which we'll be looking at in the *Transport Safety* section. Now, with the three main components of the *request message* in mind, let's look in more detail at these components.

Request Methods

The current HTTP standard (RFC 9110) allows the following tokens for the request method (sometimes called the "verb"); the following table is taken from the RFC document.

Table 11-1. *HTML request methods*

Token	Description
`GET`	Transfer a current representation of the target resource.
`HEAD`	Same as GET, but do not transfer the response content.
`POST`	Perform resource-specific processing on the request content.
`PUT`	Replace all current representations of the target resource with the request content.
`DELETE`	Remove all current representations of the target resource.
`CONNECT`	Establish a tunnel to the server identified by the target resource.
`OPTIONS`	Describe the communication options for the target resource.
`TRACE`	Perform a message loop-back test along the path to the target resource.